

Data Capture & Integration Specification

What to capture for retargeting on Meta and Google, how to send it, and what is deliberately out of scope.

Audience	Web / backend developer implementing the integration
System	Retargetng — first-party audience activation & retargeting engine
Scope	Event ingestion, ad click identifiers, identity match keys, conversions back-channel, consent
Status	Engine, ingestion API, audience engine and Meta/Google connectors are built. Items marked PLANNED are the work this document specifies.

1. The rule that shapes everything

Meta and Google **never** return a person's name, email, phone or device ID because they saw or clicked an ad. Advertisers only ever hold data that (a) the person gave to *you*, or (b) the platform passes as an opaque click identifier. Everything below respects that boundary.

✓ Can be captured	✗ Cannot be captured
Identity the customer gives you (email, phone, name, address) on signup, checkout, OTP login, forms	Name / email / phone of anyone who merely saw or clicked your ad
Behaviour on your own site/app (views, cart, purchases, search)	Device IDs of web ad viewers
Ad click identifiers on your landing pages (fbclid, gclid, ...)	The person's browsing on other websites
Lead Ads form submissions (the user typed and consented)	Another advertiser's customer list
Device advertising ID (GAID/IDFA) from <i>your own app</i> , with consent	Third-party cookie profiles (deprecated and non-compliant)

Compliance India's DPDP Act 2023 (and GDPR where applicable) requires notice and consent before personal data is processed for advertising. Meta's Custom Audience terms and Google's Customer Match policy require the same. Retargetng enforces this in code: a customer is never sent to a platform unless the consent flags for that destination are satisfied.

2. What to capture, and what each signal unlocks

Priority column: **P1** = required for the system to work, **P2** = high value, **P3** = nice to have.

2.1 Identity & match keys (from your own database / checkout)

Field	Format to send	Why it matters	Priority
email	raw string; we normalise + hash	Primary match key for Meta and Google	P1
phone	raw or E.164 (+91...)	Best match key in India; often beats email	P1

Field	Format to send	Why it matters	Priority
external_customer_id	your customer/user id	Stable identity across email/phone changes	P1
first_name, last_name	raw text	Extra match keys — Meta and Google both accept them hashed and match rate rises	P2
city, state, postal_code, country	raw text / ISO-2 country	Extra match keys; also geo audiences	P2
date_of_birth, gender	YYYY-MM-DD / m f	Extra Meta match keys	P3
GAID / IDFA (mobile app only)	raw advertising id	Highest match rate on Meta; app campaigns	P3

Quick win Match rate today is ~84%. Sending first/last name, city, state and PIN code as additional hashed keys is the cheapest way to raise it — the data is already in most customer tables.

2.2 Commerce & behaviour (from your storefront)

Signal	Retargeting use	Priority
Product viewed (product id, category)	Product / category retargeting, intent audiences	P2
Add to cart (cart id, product, qty, value)	Cart abandoner 1–3d / 4–7d / 8–14d — highest-intent audiences	P1
Checkout started	Abandoned-checkout audiences (higher intent than cart)	P2
Purchase (order id, total, items, currency)	Removes buyers from cart audiences, powers LTV/AOV/VIP tiers and ROAS	P1
Order cancelled / refunded	Corrects lifetime value; suppresses serial returners	P2
On-site search terms, wishlist	"Searched X, never bought" audiences	P3
Session recency / count, last activity	Dormant & re-engagement audiences	P3
Consent granted / revoked	Decides who may be activated at all (mandatory)	P1
Unsubscribe, complaint, fraud flag	Global suppression	P1

2.3 Ad click identifiers (captured on your landing pages)

Parameter	Source	Used for
fbclid	Meta ad click	Attribution; becomes the fbc value for Conversions API
gclid / wbraid / gbraid	Google ad click	Attribution; offline conversion & enhanced conversion import
ttclid, msclkid	TikTok / Bing	Same, for future destinations
utm_source / medium / campaign / content / term	Your ad URLs	Campaign attribution and reporting
landing page, referrer, timestamp	Browser	First-touch vs last-touch attribution

These are opaque identifiers — they carry no personal data on their own. Their value is closing the loop: revenue attributed to the exact campaign, and conversions sent back so the platforms optimise correctly.

3. Integration A — Events API (primary, already live)

Send every commerce and consent event to Retargetng. This is the only ingestion path needed for audiences to work.

Endpoint	POST {BASE_URL}/api/v1/events
Auth	Authorization: Bearer aap_live_... (create in Settings → API keys, scope events:write)
Body	A single event object, or an array of up to 1000 events
Idempotency	event_id must be unique and stable — retries and replays are ignored safely
Response	{ accepted, duplicates, rejected: [{ index, event_id, errors[] }] }
Retries	Retry on 5xx / network with exponential backoff. 4xx = fix the payload, do not retry

3.1 Envelope (every event)

```
{
  "event_id": "shopify-order-1042",           // unique + stable (idempotency key)
  "event_type": "PURCHASE_COMPLETED",        // see list below
  "occurred_at": "2026-08-23T14:21:05+05:30", // ISO-8601 with offset
  "source": "shopify",                       // free text: store/app/system
  "customer": {                             // at least one identifier required
    "external_customer_id": "cust_88431",
    "email": "priya@example.com",
    "phone": "+919876543210",
    "country": "IN"
  },
  "payload": { }                             // shape depends on event_type
}
```

3.2 Event types and payloads

event_type	payload
CUSTOMER_CREATED / CUSTOMER_UPDATED	{ region?, city?, status?, source?, created_at?, attributes?: {k:v}, consent?: { marketing, advertising_personalization, data_sharing } }
PRODUCT_VIEWED	{ product: { external_product_id, name?, sku?, brand?, price?, external_category_id?, category_name? } }
ADD_TO_CART	{ cart_id?, product: {...}, quantity, value? }
CHECKOUT_STARTED	{ cart_id?, value? }
PURCHASE_COMPLETED	{ order: { external_order_id, total, subtotal?, discount?, currency?, cart_id?, items: [{ product, quantity, unit_price, total? }] } }
ORDER_CANCELLED	{ external_order_id }
ORDER_REFUNDED	{ external_order_id, amount?, partial? }
CONSENT_GRANTED / CONSENT_REVOKED	{ purposes: { marketing, advertising_personalization, data_sharing }, source?, legal_basis?, jurisdiction?, evidence? }
CUSTOMER_DELETED	{ reason? } → erases PII, suppresses everywhere

3.3 Worked example — purchase

```
curl -X POST https://YOUR-APP/api/v1/events \
-H "authorization: Bearer aap_live_xxx" -H "content-type: application/json" \
-d '[{
  "event_id": "order-1042", "event_type": "PURCHASE_COMPLETED",
  "occurred_at": "2026-08-23T14:21:05+05:30", "source": "shopify",
  "customer": { "external_customer_id": "cust_88431", "email": "priya@example.com",
    "phone": "+919876543210", "country": "IN" },
  "payload": { "order": {
    "external_order_id": "1042", "total": 4999, "currency": "INR", "cart_id": "cart-A",
    "items": [ { "product": { "external_product_id": "SKU-RUN-12", "name": "Running Shoes",
      "external_category_id": "footwear", "price": 4999 },
      "quantity": 1, "unit_price": 4999 } ] } }
}]'
```

Consent is mandatory Send CONSENT_GRANTED (or the consent block on the customer event) with the purposes the user actually agreed to. Without advertising_personalization and data_sharing, the customer is counted but never sent to Meta or Google.

4. Integration B — Click-ID capture snippet (PLANNED)

A small first-party script on your site records the ad click identifiers and links them to the customer once they identify themselves. Nothing personal is collected before that point.

4.1 What the developer installs

```
<!-- once, before </body> on every page -->
<script async src="https://YOUR-APP/rt.js" data-site-key="rtk_live_xxx"></script>

<!-- on login / signup / checkout success, when the person is known -->
<script>
  window.rtk('identify', {
    external_customer_id: 'cust_88431',
    email: 'priya@example.com',
    phone: '+919876543210'
  });
</script>
```

4.2 What it sends automatically

- **First-party visitor id** in a first-party cookie (rt_vid, 180 days) — no third-party cookies.
- **Click identifiers** from the landing URL: fbclid, gclid, wbraid, gbraid, ttclid, msclkid and all utm_* parameters.
- **Page context**: landing path, referrer, timestamp, first-touch and last-touch values.
- **Optional behaviour** if you prefer not to send it server-side: product views, add-to-cart, checkout start.

Endpoint: POST /api/v1/collect (site key, no secret in the browser). On identify the anonymous visit history and click IDs are attached to the customer record.

4.3 Platform-specific install notes

Platform	How	Effort
Shopify	Settings → Customer events → Add custom pixel , paste the snippet. Order/customer data comes from webhooks (below) — no theme edits.	~10 min
WooCommerce / WordPress	Insert the script tag via your header plugin; hook woocommerce_thankyou for identify	~30 min
Custom site (Next.js, Rails, Laravel...)	Script tag in the root layout; call rtk('identify', ...) after login/checkout	~1 h

Platform	How	Effort
Mobile app	Post the same fields from the app (plus GAID/IDFA with consent) to /api/v1/events	app release cycle

5. Integration C — Store webhooks → events

Map your platform's webhooks to the event types in §3.2. This is the reliable server-side source of truth; the browser snippet is only for click IDs and optional behaviour.

Your webhook	Send as
customers/create, customers/update	CUSTOMER_CREATED / CUSTOMER_UPDATED (include the consent block)
carts/update, checkouts/create	ADD_TO_CART / CHECKOUT_STARTED
orders/create (or paid)	PURCHASE_COMPLETED
orders/cancelled	ORDER_CANCELLED
refunds/create	ORDER_REFUNDED
customers/data_erasure, GDPR/DPDP delete	CUSTOMER_DELETED
marketing consent change / unsubscribe	CONSENT_REVOKED

Use the platform's own object id in `event_id` (e.g. `shopify-order-1042`) so webhook retries are naturally idempotent.

6. Integration D — Conversions back-channel (PLANNED)

Purchases are sent *back* to the ad platforms with hashed identifiers and the original click ID. This is what makes the platforms optimise properly and what raises reported match and attribution quality.

Platform	Mechanism	What we send	You provide
Meta	Conversions API (server-side)	<code>event_name</code> , <code>event_time</code> , <code>event_id</code> (dedup with your pixel), hashed <code>em/ph/fn/ln/ct/st/zp/country/db/ge</code> , <code>external_id</code> , <code>fbclid</code> (from <code>fbclid</code>), <code>fbp</code> , client IP + user agent, value + currency	System-user access token, Pixel/Dataset ID, ad account
Google	Enhanced Conversions / offline conversion import	<code>gclid</code> (or <code>wbraid/gbraid</code>), conversion action, time, value, hashed email/phone/name/address	OAuth client + refresh token, developer token, conversion action id

De-duplication If you keep the Meta Pixel on the site, the browser event and the server event must share the same `event_id` so Meta counts one conversion, not two. Retargetng generates and stores that id — pass it to the pixel call.

7. Integration E — Lead Ads (PLANNED, only if you run lead-gen ads)

- **Meta:** subscribe a webhook to the `leadgen` field on your Page; on each notification we fetch the lead via the Graph API and create a customer with the consent captured on the form.
- **Google:** configure the lead-form extension webhook (URL + key); the payload is posted directly to us.
- Requires: a Meta app with `leads_retrieval` + `pages_manage_ads`, and Page admin approval.

8. Normalisation & hashing (handled by Retargetng — for your reference)

Send raw values; the platform normalises and hashes them per destination, stores only the hashes for activation, and encrypts the raw values at rest (AES-256-GCM). Raw PII never appears in logs, exports or the dashboard.

Field	Meta	Google
Email	trim, lowercase → SHA-256 hex	trim, lowercase; for gmail/googlemail remove dots and +suffix → SHA-256 hex
Phone	digits only with country code, no '+' → SHA-256 hex	E.164 with '+' → SHA-256 hex
Name / city / state	lowercase, strip punctuation → SHA-256	lowercase, strip whitespace → SHA-256
Postal code / country	first 5 chars / ISO-2, lowercase → SHA-256	as provided → SHA-256

9. Suggested order of work

#	Deliverable	Owner	Effort
1	Extra match keys included in the customer feed (name, city, state, PIN, country)	Your dev + Retargetng	0.5 day
2	Store webhooks → /api/v1/events (customers, carts, orders, refunds, consent)	Your dev	0.5–1 day
3	Capture snippet + identify() on login/checkout (click IDs, stitching)	Your dev (10 min) + Retargetng (1 day)	1 day
4	Conversions back-channel to Meta + Google (with dedup)	Retargetng, needs your tokens	1–2 days
5	Lead Ads ingestion	Retargetng + your Meta app approval	1 day
6	App SDK events + GAID/IDFA with ATT consent	Your mobile dev	app release

10. What we need from you to start

- Storefront platform and stack (Shopify / WooCommerce / custom — framework and language).
- Whether a mobile app exists (decides if device IDs are in scope at all).
- Whether you run lead-generation ads with on-platform forms.
- Where consent is captured today (checkout tick-box, preference centre, WhatsApp opt-in) and whether it is stored per purpose.
- A sample export of 20 customer rows and 20 order rows (headers + dummy values) so field mapping can be finalised.
- For the live back-channel: Meta system-user token + pixel/dataset id, Google OAuth credentials + developer token.

Non-negotiables No scraping, no purchased lists, no fingerprinting, no de-anonymisation, and no upload of anyone who opted out. Every activation passes the consent gate; suppression and deletion propagate to every destination automatically.